

Google Music versus iTunes

The Apple versus Google war will touch the clouds when Google Music faces iTunes

MeeGo-powered Nokia N9 phone

The N9 will be Nokia's first and last smartphone running the Linux-based MeeGo OS

Bazaar

Audio-Technica ATH-AD300

Unmatched Comfort

Even before actually trying on the pair, a few things will stand out. The lattice grill at the back of the driver cups is something that will instantly catch your eye. With Audio-Technica's signature wing design, the 200g weight (which is quite light to begin with) is barely felt on your noggin. They're supremely comfortable.

The build quality of the headphones is a bit of a paradox. They don't seem to be badly built, but at the same time give you the impression of being flimsy.

The sound on most tracks had a spacious feel to it. Being open cans, there was hardly any pressure. There is little or no iso-

lation to speak of. While this is not a headphone for bass heads, to its credit we should say that it played our 30Hz sample which is usually an accomplishment in itself for headphones in this price range. However the sample wasn't as hard-hitting as it should have been. The bass sounded less impactful and a little loose even. Cymbals are extremely pronounced thanks to the accentuated highs. Vocals are near-neutral, sharp, rich and pleasing. The sound sig-



nature of the ATH AD-300 is decidedly bright, even bordering on the sibilant but most non-discerning ears won't notice anything amiss. The sound quality is above average and the comfort is phenomenal. At a price of ₹3,550 the ATH-AD300 make for a perfect maiden purchase for anyone gingerly taking their first steps into the audiophile arena. Since they've been officially discontinued, availability may be an issue.

Siddharth Parwatay

Specifications

Driver Type: Open-air
Dynamic; **Driver size:** 40 mm
Frequency response: 20 - 25,000 Hz; **Maximum input power:** 300 mW
Sensitivity: 96 dB/mW at 1 kHz; **Impedance:** 32 ohms

Contact

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MRP: ₹3,800 **SRP:** ₹3,550

7.0
10

Features.....6.0
Performance.....7.0
Build Quality6.0
Value for Money 7.0

Cooler Master CM Storm Spawn

Nice and cosy!

For all those gamers out there who use a claw grip, Cooler Master's CM Storm Spawn vies for your attention. Packed in an attractive box, the Spawn is quite a snazzy mouse. It has a two-toned color scheme with a blend of metallic red and dull black finish. It instantly grabs your attention, quite unlike a glowing Alienware mouse. The CM Storm Spawn is highly ergonomic and easy to grip, courtesy of rubber coating around the side. We personally like the Spawn's extra groove to rest your ring finger; it enables better than average claw grip and is a testimony to the mouse's ergonomics. The product is light and doesn't have the option of adding weights.



The CM Storm Spawn comes with a gold-plated USB plug at the end of a two-metre long cable. There are two customizable buttons on the mouse's left rubber grip, which can be programmed with macros via software downloaded from www.cmstorm.com The mouse has built-in anti drift controls to prevent wayward pointer movements while lifting or dropping the Spawn. The CM Storm Spawn also offers two dedicated buttons below the scroll wheel for on-the-fly DPI changes. However, we find the three predefined

levels – only at 800, 1800 and 3500 DPI – a bit limiting.

Gaming with the Spawn is very good. We experienced absolutely no issues with the claw grip design. After a small learning curve and with enough time, even large hands can adapt to the Spawn. Response time was great, there was no lag while playing games like Crysis 2 and Brink, and on-the-fly DPI tweaking was instantaneous. Movement was fine, the mouse gripped the table surface well and there was no unnecessary skidding. The Omron Micro switches – good for five million clicks – make clicks feel soft, nice and cosy. The Spawn is definitely worth a try, especially for FPS gamers.

Jayesh Shinde

7.0
10

Features.....6.5
Performance.....7.0
Build Quality8.0
Value for Money 7.0